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CHENNAI PETROLEUM CORPORATION LIMITED (CPCL)

At 60, This Indian Refiner Is Fueling Fighter Jets And a 280% Stock Surge

Chennai Petroleum's diamond anniversary comes with rocket fuel innovations, net-zero ambitions, and a playbook that's rewarding both shareholders and India's defence establishment.



H. Shankar, Managing Director, CPCL

When a state-owned refinery delivers a 280% market capitalization jump while simultaneously becoming the exclusive supplier of missile fuel to India's defence forces, it commands attention. Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited (CPCL), marking its 60th year in 2025, has quietly engineered one of India's most compelling corporate transformations—blending strategic national priorities with shareholder returns that would make any CFO envious.

The Indian Oil subsidiary declared its highest-ever dividend of ₹55 per share in FY 2023-24, capping three years of disciplined growth that saw profit after tax peak at ₹3,534 crore in FY 2022-23. But the real story lies in how CPCL achieved it: by focussing on innovation, operational excellence, sustainability and inclusive growth.

“Our Diamond Jubilee marks a proud moment in CPCL's journey—a time to build on our rich legacy and embrace new possibilities,” says H. Shankar, Managing Director. “Our focus now turns to shaping new frontiers—transformative projects to expand our presence across the energy value chain. With innovation and sustainability at the core, CPCL is evolving into a future-ready energy enterprise, creating lasting value for the nation.”

That evolution is tangible. Collaborations are on with the Manali Industrial Area focus on specialty petrochemicals and retail marketing rights for MS and HSD position CPCL to expand into the downstream value chain and shape a new vision for the company. CPCL produces, ISROSENE, a rocket propellant fuel for ISRO and ‘Vajravega (JP-7)’ missile fuel—earning the Federation of Indian Petroleum Industry's ‘Innovator of the Year’. The company's 10.5 million metric ton

capacity includes India's only integrated lube and wax facility and has recently earned an upgrade to Schedule ‘A’ PSU status. Surpassing throughput records and achieving best-ever energy metrics reflect our team's dedication. From strategic fuel innovations to sustainable practices, we're shaping a future-ready refinery ecosystem that aligns with national priorities and global benchmarks in performance and environmental stewardship.

“At CPCL, operational excellence is driven by precision, innovation, and resilience. Surpassing throughput records and achieving best-ever energy metrics reflect our team's dedication. From strategic fuel innovations to sustainable practices, we're shaping a future-ready refinery ecosystem that aligns with national priorities and global benchmarks in performance and environmental stewardship,” states P. Kannan, Director (Operations).

Those metrics are impressive: a record crude throughput of 11.642 MMT in FY 2023-24, top-quartile ranking in the Solomon Benchmark Study for energy efficiency, and a 20% reduction in water

footprint last year alone.

The financial discipline underpinning this growth hasn't gone unnoticed. “CPCL's financial journey over the past three years reflects disciplined growth, strategic investments, and robust returns, notes Rohit Kumar Agrawala, Director of Finance. “From record profits and dividends to market capitalization gains, we've built a resilient financial foundation. Our focus remains on value creation, operational efficiency, and supporting national energy goals through prudent fiscal management and innovation.”



Rohit Kumar Agrawala,
Director (Finance)



P. Kannan
Director Operations

Looking ahead, CPCL is betting big: a grassroots refinery at Nagapattinam with Indian Oil, Group-II/III lube oil projects to cut imports, and aggressive decarbonisation through sustainable aviation fuel, carbon capture, and green hydrogen—targeting net-zero by 2046. With research partnerships across IIT Madras and other premier institutions, CPCL is positioning itself as an integrated energy player navigating India's transition while keeping both the national arsenal and shareholder portfolios well-fuelled.